

David Kelley & Tom Kelley

IDEO, the d.school & Creative Confidence

David b. 1951 · Tom b. 1955 · Founders/leaders of IDEO; David founded the Stanford d.school

[portrait]

David Kelley

1 WHY THIS THINKER MATTERS

The Kelley brothers built both the institution (IDEO, the d.school) and the mindset (creative confidence) that make design thinking learnable by anyone. If you have ever done an empathy interview or a rapid prototype in class, you are working in their tradition.

2 INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

David Kelley founded IDEO and the Hasso Plattner Institute of Design (d.school) at Stanford. Tom Kelley, an IDEO partner and author, documented the firm's methods. Together they translated professional design practice into teachable methods and a belief in everyone's creative capacity.

"Creative confidence is the natural ability to come up with new ideas and the courage to try them out."

"Enlightened trial and error succeeds over the planning of the lone genius."

3 FRAMEWORKS · TOOLS · MODELS

NAME	WHAT IT IS
Creative Confidence	The belief that anyone can be creative — and act on it
Human-centred design process	Empathise, define, ideate, prototype, test
Rapid prototyping	Make ideas tangible fast to learn
The Ten Faces of Innovation	Innovation roles teams need (Tom Kelley)
The d.school method	Studio pedagogy for design thinking

4 HOW IT'S OPERATIONALIZED

- Build creative confidence through small, guided wins
- Lead with empathy fieldwork before ideation
- Prototype in hours to test assumptions cheaply
- Staff teams across the innovation 'faces'/roles
- Use studio-style, learning-by-doing pedagogy

5 LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUES

- 'Anyone can be creative' can understate domain expertise
- Methods depend on skilled facilitation to work
- Popular framing, limited controlled evidence
- Risk of superficial adoption ('sticky-note theatre')
- Less focus on scaling and measurement

6 ENDURING IMPACT

- Founded IDEO and the Stanford d.school
- Popularised empathy and prototyping as core skills
- *Creative Confidence* and *The Art of Innovation* shaped practice
- Direct anchor for BCOBM126 Units 3, 5 and 8
- Trained a generation of design thinkers and educators

SELECTED WORKS

CREATIVE CONFIDENCE

Unleashing the Creative Potential in Us All

KELLEY & KELLEY · 2013

THE ART OF INNOVATION

Lessons from IDEO

T. KELLEY · 2001

THE TEN FACES OF INNOVATION

Doubleday

T. KELLEY · 2005

CHANGE BY DESIGN (contrib.)

IDEO methods

IDEO · 2009

REFERENCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

Kelley, T. and Kelley, D. (2013) *Creative Confidence*. New York: Crown Business.
Kelley, T. (2001) *The Art of Innovation*. New York: Currency/Doubleday.